MATTEO MARRALE

Junior QA Tester | Game Designer

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PROFILE

Junior QA Tester with Game Designer training at Digital Bros Game Academy in Milan (until summer 2027) and enrolled in the DBGA QA Testing course (from November 2026). Across 4 game projects I have written bug reports, organized playtest feedback and followed balancing to the final build. Game design helps me understand what a system should do before I test it. Two years in airport security at Malpensa taught me to follow strict procedures and notice details.

SKILLS

QA & Testing: bug reporting, playtesting, sorting feedback (incl. Google Forms), balancing & tuning, reading the GDD for expected behavior
Game Design: core mechanics, gameplay loop, level design, scoring & progression systems
Tools: Unity (URP, New Input System), Unreal Engine, Figma, Miro, ClickUp, Notion, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office, Git basics, Claude Code, Claude Cowork
Documentation: GDD, bug reports, playtest reports, pitch deck, technical design docs
Languages: Italian (native), English B1 (GDDs and dialogue written in English)

ACADEMIC PROJECTS — DIGITAL BROS GAME ACADEMY

Antiques: The Last Owner — *Narrative Designer & Writer* May–Jul 2026
First-person restoration simulator with supernatural elements, PC, Unity (URP). 6 in-game days, 3 ghosts, 6 objects to restore. Team 02 of 14, released 3 July 2026.

- Narrative design of the core concept (object → ghost → regret → ritual), with a "funny with a human undertone" tone, woven into the gameplay loop.
- Wrote two of the three ghosts (Eleanor, a Victorian lady, and Anselmo, a medieval soldier) and their in-game dialogue in English, with triggers, word counts and notes for programmers.
- Beat chart for the 6 days and tutorial texts (IT + EN) delivered diegetically: each day introduces a mechanic without text tutorials.

One Hell of a Casino — *Producer* Mar–Apr 2026
Hell-themed casual mobile game (Android): mini-game collection, gacha system and simulated monetization. Team 02 of 15.

- Coordinated a multidisciplinary team (4 designers, 5 programmers, 5 artists) over 6 weeks, through to release.
- Managed milestones (Alpha 29/03, Beta 10/04, Release 24/04) and cross-discipline dependencies.
- Created the feedback form (Google Forms) to collect testers' impressions of the beta.
- Delivered on time with Android APK, pitch, walkthrough, promo art and technical documentation.

Cosmic Chaos — *Game & Level Designer, Testing & Balancing* Feb 2026
Space Invaders reimagined with a "twist" mechanic and enemy spawn patterns. "Shuffle" format: the project moves to another team every 5 days. Team 03.

- Co-wrote the GDD with the team and designed the twist and the enemy spawn and movement patterns (several enemy types, differentiated scoring, blocking object).
- Testing, bug reports and balancing analysis (difficulty curve, usefulness of elements), with tuning up to the final build.
- Pickup-and-continue: took over work started by other teams and handed off my own clearly.

What a Train — *Game & Level Designer* Jan 2026
5-day game jam — theme "origin of music", side camera, 26-second run, at least 1 mandatory diversifier.

- From brainstorm to playable prototype in 5 days: designed an experience compressed into 26 seconds, prioritizing and cutting features.

The Hunger of Nigishida — *Game & Level Designer* Nov–Dec 2025
Snake-like arcade game set in Sumerian mythology: top-down, 3 levels, scoring and power-ups. Team 02 of 8, first Unity project.

- Game and level design for one of the 3 levels; co-designed the score system, items (Beer, Speed Potion) and NPC rules.
- After internal testing, collected the feedback into a list of 17 changes assigned to team members.
- Wrote the GDD in English (core loop, mechanics, NPC behavior, level design, UI/UX, audio spec), with the Sumerian theme throughout.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Cat 'n' Hell! — *Personal project* Jul 2026 – present
Playable PC prototype; narrative and lore by Said Serbouti; I use Claude Code for programming.

- Playtested the prototype and listed bugs and fixes for the 1.0 demo (e.g. cleared waves restarting, boss fight triggering early).

Other Side — *Personal project* Sep 2026 – present
A first-person, turn-based dungeon crawler with permadeath, developed in Unity. You beat each enemy by using your items and the room around you. When you die, you start over: all you keep between runs is a journal you draw and write in yourself.

Fighting Ground — *Personal project* Oct 2026 – present
Hand-to-hand combat inspired by Sifu and a hex world map inspired by For The King; new moves are stolen from enemies' cyberdecks. Beat 'em Up Action RPG · Unreal Engine · combat prototype · working title.

All Bullets for Me — *Personal project* Oct 2026 – present
An FPS built on combining weapons and powers. Unreal Engine · early mechanic tests · working title.

EDUCATION

Digital Bros Game Academy — QA Testing online course (Plug-N-Learn, 60 hours) enrolled, starts 11 Nov 2026

Digital Bros Game Academy — Game Design course, Milan Oct 2025 – summer 2027 (ongoing)
Design documentation, Unity prototyping, level design, mobile game design, project management, Unreal Engine, advanced system design, game audio, AR/VR.

AIV — Accademia Italiana Videogiochi — Strategic Writing & Screenwriting (first year completed), Milan Sep 2023 – Jun 2024
Story structure, character development and narrative analysis applied to games, film and TV.

Vocational diploma in Industrial and Craft Production — IIS "A. Ponti", Gallarate (70/100) 2020 – 2022

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Airport Security Officer — I-SEC, Milan Malpensa Airport (Jun 2023 – Jul 2025): security procedures, attention to detail, shift teamwork. School internships as a machine operator (2016–2017).

INTERESTS

Game design and critical analysis of games, narrative writing, comics, arthouse cinema, literature, philosophy, art history.

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